

1. ? Follow-Up Thoughts on Watermarking Schemes for AI-Generated Text

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-18T00:55:13Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/08/follow-up_thoughts_on_watermarking

I want the answers that I read to be cogent, lucid, accurate, blessedly terse ? and ideally to strike a consistent tone that is pleasant to my reading ear. The genie is not going back in the bottle.

2. Apple TV Still Has No Start Date for ?The Savant?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-17T21:55:29Z

Link: <https://daringfireball.net/linked/2026/04/19/chastain-says-the-savant-will-be-released>

The Savant is a political thriller series starring Jessica Chastain that was supposed to debut a year ago . Apple ?postponed? it, apparently out of fear of upsetting extremist right-wing nut jobs because the show is about an undercover investigator (Chastain) hunting down extremist right-wing nut jobs. Chastain was not happy about the show being delayed. Last we heard about the show was back in April, when Marc Malkin reported this for Variety : ?Before it was like, ?I don?t know if we?re going to see it,? but now I can say, ?We?re going to see it,?? Chastain told me exclusively on Saturday at the Breakthrough Prize ceremony in Santa Monica. As for when, sources tell me that Apple is planning for a July release. Given that it?s now the middle of August, I think that a July release is looking less and less likely by the day. ?

3. No Update Since Early July Regarding Siri AI Coming to the EU, Ever

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-17T21:43:50Z

Link: <https://www.ft.com/content/807d25c3-f4ac-4402-b815-3aa91018237d>

The Financial Times, back on July 1, with the transcontinental byline ?Michael Acton in San Francisco and Barbara Moens in Brussels? (non-paywalled summaries from 9to5Mac and MacRumors): Apple chief executive Tim Cook and EU tech chief Henna Virkkunen held ?constructive? talks on Tuesday as the two sides aim to lower the temperature in a bitter dispute over the iPhone maker?s new ?Siri AI.? An EU spokesperson said the virtual meeting had involved a ?constructive exchange on topics of common interest, on which the work continues?. The meeting included a discussion of how Apple can launch its reinvented Siri in Europe while avoiding millions of dollars in fines for violating the bloc?s flagship competition rules, according to two people familiar with the talks. [9 paragraphs of explanatory backstory on the Siri AI/DMA standoff elided ...] The dispute triggered a fierce public backlash against the commission, with European officials reporting hundreds of emails from consumers accusing Brussels of depriving Europeans of a new technology. One EU official said that a commission spokesperson had received a stream of abusive messages, including several death threats. If there are actual...

4. Qwen 3.8 27B scores 52 on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-17T23:58:14+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/17/qwen-38-27b-scores-52/>

Qwen 3.8 27B scores 52 on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index That's the same score as GPT-5.6 Luna (max), and just one point behind GLM-5.2 (max) and DeepSeek V4 Pro 0813 (max) - that GLM is 753B and that DeepSeek is 1.6B parameters, and Luna is size unknown but presumably a whole lot bigger than 27B. Qwen 3.8 27B is a truly astonishing model . Via Hacker News Tags: ai , generative-ai , llms , qwen , ai-in-china , artificial-analysis

5. We Tracked a Shipment of Rare Books. It Ended at an Amazon AI Training Facility

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-17T15:21:29+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/17/we-tracked-a-shipment-of-rare-books-it-ended-at-an-amazon-ai-tra/>

We Tracked a Shipment of Rare Books. It Ended at an Amazon AI Training Facility Excellent piece of reporting from 404 Media. For a while now there have been stories of book dealers receiving

orders for large volumes of books from apparently price-insensitive anonymous customers, widely suspected to be companies looking to scan them for AI training (see my previous coverage of Anthropic's book scanning from June 2025.) 404 Media investigated with an AirTag! In July, one bookseller told me they received a very large order of around 1,000 books on Biblio, one of these marketplaces. The seller agreed to put an Apple AirTag provided by 404 Media in one of the books included in this order so we could see where the book was going. And by extension, which company, AI or otherwise, was behind this massive order. The book ended up delivered to the VGT3 corner of the LAS8 Amazon facility in the north east of Las Vegas, where the entrance carried this on-the-nose logo of a dinosaur with a book! Photo credit: 404 Media Online forum discussions between Amazon workers confirmed that VGT3 destructively scans large volumes of books. Tags: amazon , journalism , ai , training-data , ai-ethics , 404-...

6. datasette-upload-dbs 0.5a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-11T20:35:13+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/11/datasette-upload-dbs/>

Release: datasette-upload-dbs 0.5a0 This plugin has been around for a while - it lets users upload a brand new SQLite database to a hosted Datasette instance, at which point that database will start being served by that instance. It can also be used to atomically swap a database with a more recent version. The uploaded database is saved to a file, verified, then swapped in so /name starts serving the new one. The new release adds a formalized API, so you can replace an existing database (or add a new one) like this: `curl -X POST \ -H "Authorization: Bearer $API_TOKEN" \ -H "Accept: application/json" \ -F "db=@content.db" \ -F "db_name=content" \ https://your-instance.example.com/-/upload-dbs` This means you can build fresh databases in an environment such as GitHub Actions and swap them in production as soon as that build has completed. Tags: datasette

7. How do functions like alloca allocate memory from the stack?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 17 Aug 2026 15:54:40 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260817-40/?p=112617>

The usual probing. The post How do functions like alloca allocate memory from the stack? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. And then the men with guns tell you to do it anyway

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Mon, 17 Aug 2026 11:34:24 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/and-then-the-men-with-guns-tell-you-to-do-it-anyway/>

In early February 2011 Egypt was in the middle of a political revolution. One morning, everyone's phones suddenly pinged with an alert. The Armed Forces asks Egypt's honest and loyal men to confront the traitors and criminals and protect our people and honour and our precious Egypt. A series of messages arrived all ostensibly from the network provider Vodafone. All pro-regime and all with the?

9. Edinburgh Fringe - James Rowland: Team Viking ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Wed, 12 Aug 2026 19:20:01 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-james-rowland-team-viking/>

This is a technically precise and emotionally complex show with energetic delivery from a talented performer. Sadly, it did nothing for me. I found it a little one note in terms of storytelling. The rhythm of the story followed all the predictable beats which I thought was a little repetitive. There's no doubt he's a gifted storyteller. The comedy is suitably dark with some good moments of joy ?

10. Edinburgh Fringe - Garrett Millerick: We Tried it Your Way ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Wed, 12 Aug 2026 17:55:57 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-garrett-millerick-we-tried-it-your-way/>

Easily the worst show we've seen at the fringe. Garrett Millerick has trained an AI on his stand up. Can it replace him? Yes, but only in the sense that the AI is obnoxiously dull and

Millerick is simply obnoxious. He insulted a kid who he'd called on to stage to help him. Not even in a jokey way, just being rude. His splenetic rants against religion and politics were beyond tired. The dating?

11. Oops, Should've Thought of That

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Sun, 16 Aug 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/oops-shouldve-thought-of-that/>

Gordon Brander writes : The thing about computers is that they can do anything you wish, so long as you specify your wish in exacting detail. However, LLMs relieve this constraint. An LLM can extrapolate what you mean (more or less) from just a few words. So computers can do vibes now. It used to be that computers could only ever do exactly what you told them to do, nothing more. If they did something unexpected (a.k.a. a bug), it was because you failed to 1) anticipate it could happen, or 2) specify with greater detail that it shouldn't happen. But in this new world, computers can extrapolate your intent. LLMS can act like a fill-in-the-gap machine, which alleviates you from the pedantic demands of coding from years past . There's going to be a lot more "Oops, I didn't mean to do that" in the future. This should be what separates professional practitioners from hobbyists. A good practitioner recognizes that leveraging some foresight is part and parcel of the job in order to mitigate unintended consequences. Meanwhile, a hobbyist or amateur doesn't even have the capability or experience to understand the assumed intent of an LLM until it's too late and users have been affected. So...

12. Quake Shareware, a CD-ROM just a little too full

Source: Fabien Sanglard | Published: 17 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: https://fabiensanglard.net/quake_shareware_cd/index.html

(No summary)

13. Pluralistic: Jennifer Jenkins' 'Music Copyright, Creativity, and Culture' (17 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Mon, 17 Aug 2026 07:00:08 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/17/great-sousas-ghost/>

Today's links Jennifer Jenkins' 'Music Copyright, Creativity, and Culture': The definitive textbook (with comics!). Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Hair-gel bombers v bras; Hair-gel bombers v chemistry; AOL digs for spammer's platinum; Stross on infosec in 2061; In-game Ponzi; Snowden on Shadow Brokers hack; Life v understanding advanced math; "Greatest of Marlys!"; Housing and precarity; LLMs as slot-machines for coders; Hypercard's backstory; Pirate Party; Fanbois' mental health v critics; Krugman calls for alien invasion; Trump x Serbian genocidaires; The last Sandman Slim; Muphry's Law; NSA created the Shadow Brokers; DOJ kills private prisons; Walmart externalizes crime; "Sgt Augmento"; Zuckermuskian solipsism. Upcoming appearances: Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Jennifer Jenkins' 'Music Copyright, Creativity, and Culture' (permalink) Nobody explains copyright like Jennifer Jenkins, the director of the Duke Center for the Public Domain, in which capacity she is r...